

The Message in the Bottle: answers

Grade 6 · 13 points. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. On the Oregon coast. (1 point)

Finding information (RL.6.1). A fact to find in the first paragraph before the harder questions begin.

2. Bored. Any two of: she wandered along the waterline kicking pebbles; the word “bored”; three days of gray skies and cold wind; she had “run out of things to do”. (2 points)

Inference (RL.6.1). Citing evidence means naming specific details from the text that prove a claim.

3. It shone or sparkled briefly, catching the light. (1 point)

Word meaning (RL.6.4). Understanding a precise verb and what it shows.

4. There were many questions, they were busy and hard to ignore, and she was excited and curious. (2 points)

Language choices (RL.6.4). Explaining what a simile suggests about a character’s mind.

5. “For the first time all week, she wasn’t bored at all.” It shows that her boredom has been replaced by excitement and curiosity. (2 points)

Quoting from the text (RL.6.1). A quote plus an explanation: the Grade 6 skill of using the text as proof.

6. It was very old, or had been floating for a long time. The paper was “yellowed,” the ink had “faded,” and the date was fourteen years ago. (2 points)

Inference (RL.6.1). A conclusion that has to be supported with more than one detail.

7. She was curious and excited. The note asked for a reply (“Please write back”), she wondered who the writer was now, and it ended her boredom. (2 points)

Explaining from the text. Linking a character’s choice to evidence in the story.

8. D (1 point)

Summarizing (RL.6.2). A theme is a big idea the whole story supports. The wrong answers focus on small or untrue details.